

Assimilation by Meditation

We are studying the laws of meditation, so let us go to Psalm 1 and review briefly.

We are continuing our study into the kind of meditation that causes the Word to become part of you and causes you to become part of it. Jesus said:

If ye abide in me, and my words abide in you, ye shall ask what ye will, and it shall be done unto you.

His Word becomes part of you; you become part of it. You become part of Him; He becomes part of you. Then you can ask what you will, and it shall be done.

There is a place in Him.

Last Friday night I talked about three of the greatest things that ever happened to me. One was the first time blind eyes opened. The second was when two college professors, one who taught language and the other speech, wanted to talk to me. I thought they wanted to correct my grammar, but they wanted to know who taught me how to meditate. The third was when Bernard, a professor of journalism, wanted to know who taught me how to write and capture thoughts.

Again, I had to say it was the Holy Spirit.

Those moments were great to me because Grandpa always told me I would never amount to anything. When he got mad, I guess he saw my dad in me. He would say, "You are no good. You never will be. You will never amount to anything."

That got into me.

Then I was born again in holiness, and the way they preached about God, I thought He was as mad at me as my dad was when he left us. Then I found out He is good. He made me righteous, and I could run to Him with my problems.

At about age thirty, I went full-time in ministry and discovered praying in the Holy Ghost. For three to six months, I did not know that praying in tongues had become the source of revelation knowledge flowing into my life.

During that first year, I lost my mind and picked up the mind of Christ. He began to teach me that I was worth something, that I could learn and amount to something. As I kept transforming, I kept losing my old man and gaining Christ, losing my old mind and gaining Christ.

Seven years after I went full-time, I walked into Grace Fellowship and preached my first revival to thousands of people. Tape sales in the first six months topped \$25,000 in a month. I thought I had died and gone to heaven.

When you get to know Jesus through praying in the Holy Ghost, and the Holy Spirit begins to reveal Him in you, intense hunger and desire come from the Holy Spirit empowering your soul with the new nature.

Whether you are a lawyer, preacher, prophet, or businessman, it does not matter. When the Holy Ghost takes that new nature and rises up to seize your soul, that is where intense hunger comes from.

As years went by, I found certain things I could do to assist the Holy Spirit in the transformation process as He transformed my soul with that new nature. If I never go to the Word, or rarely go to it, I make the ministry of the Holy Spirit very difficult, even though I am praying in the Holy Ghost.

Some of the first things He taught me were how to meditate and how to give myself to the Word.

I know I am called to preach, handle the Word, and teach the Word. But if you think God respects me more than you in meditation and revelation knowledge, I can promise you He does not.

Whether you are apostle, prophet, teacher, government, businessman, or called to help as a steward of God's money, God wants you to know what is in His Word.

Why am I up here teaching you? Because God wants you to know what I know. If He wants you to know what I know, why would He limit you to me? Why would He limit you to one avenue of teaching?

God will seize every opportunity to transform you to the Word. He will use the Holy Ghost, examples, teaching, and every possible avenue.

The teaching gift is an anointing to deliver the Word. I do not have a corner on the market. I have no more access to revelation knowledge than you do. As you get in there, God will teach you the same things He taught me.

My gift is the ability to communicate it. When that gift comes on me, it reaches into revelation I have stored up and uses my mind to deliver it.

You can stand before God and receive all you want from Him just because you want to. I can teach you how to enter into the holiest of holies, stand in the presence of God, and take a bath in revelation knowledge with no other human being involved.

Praying in tongues is the most valuable aid to meditation I know.

All the mysteries you pray, according to 1 Corinthians 14, are the mystery of Christ in you, to you, and through you, the hope of glory. Eventually God will answer the mysteries you spend extended time praying.

Prophecy edifies the Church because the mind of Christ is spoken collectively to the Church. Praying in tongues edifies the individual because the mind of Christ, the mysteries of Christ, will be revealed in that person.

God set this up so that locking yourself in the prayer closet benefits you, and praying while you drive or go about business also benefits you. If you have a job where you can pray under your breath hour after hour, it benefits you.

He left your brain out for a reason. He is building edification in your spirit to invade your soul against the day the mysteries of Christ in you, through you, and to you are understood by you.

The day you decide to pray much at all, you have entered the classroom of the Holy Ghost. He becomes the minister of your understanding, wisdom, divine insight, and the mysteries of Christ in you.

The more I pray in the Holy Ghost, the more that new nature invades my soul and the more intense my hunger becomes. Then I want to give myself to God any way I can.

Jesus said:

| The words that I speak unto you, they are spirit, and they are life.

If you are looking for the life of God, you can find it in His words. If you want to transform to the Holy Spirit, transform to what Jesus said. His words are spirit.

There are laws I can give myself to in meditating His Word that assist the transformation of my soul. When I found out how the soul works, it sped the process of God inside me.

Why can a child by age five assimilate two or three languages and speak them fluently without trying?

Most of you have assimilated at least two languages. One is your natural language. Another is tongues, though that one does not require your mind, so I do not count it intellectually.

When we try to learn a language later in school, we usually compare one word intellectually to another word: Portuguese to English, Spanish to English. That uses only one attribute of the soul, the intellect.

But the soul has mind, will, intellect, and emotions. Emotions are one of the most powerful transforming attributes of the soul, and often the last area to change because they empower strongholds.

If you learn to meditate His Word using all the attributes of the soul, you move from intellectual consent to assimilation. The Word becomes part of you, and you become part of it.

The soul was created by God to transform you into whatever you give it to the most.

I realized the reason I was not a millionaire by age thirty was that I did not think like one. I had never been transformed to be a millionaire before becoming one. You become a millionaire before you become a millionaire. Most of us are not millionaires because we live in strongholds that do not allow us to be.

Strongholds in the soul are as strong as prison bars. You could escape from Leavenworth faster than you can escape the prison of your soul when you have been raised in a stronghold, unless it is pulled down and you are transformed.

If we flew you over a remote Brazilian village with no English-speaking people and threw you out, then picked you up in two or three years, your soul would transform you to Portuguese. You would not have to think and translate; it would become spontaneous.

When your soul assimilates something, including the Word of God, you do not have to stop and think, "What would God say about this?" It becomes spontaneous because it has become part of you.

Jesus said:

| If my words abide in you...

He wants me to teach you how you can cooperate with the Holy Spirit in your transformation, supplying Him the cooperation of your soul as He works through the new nature in your spirit to transform you to what the Word says you are.

When someone comes to me hungry for the Word or wanting to know how to equip themselves for their call, I often give them a starting point.

Some of you are called to the steward ministry, which is what I have discovered helps to be: a man called to make and handle God's money. God can trust him with billions.

For that gift, I usually direct them to the book of Proverbs. It is a good starting book.

I tell them to read it fifty times, deliberately and precisely. Understand every word you read. If you come across a word you do not understand, write it down and find out what it means in that verse, because it is hard to meditate on a verse if you do not know what a key word means.

Whether you succeed in your calling depends on whether you can become in that calling what God says you are.

This is not the only way to study the Word. But for jump-starting a calling, especially helps or stewardship, Proverbs equips the soul with wisdom.

Read every verse deliberately and precisely. Do not go on to the next verse until you have acknowledged the content of the one you just read. You do not have to know all it means, but you must acknowledge what it says.

I trained myself to pray under my breath in the Holy Ghost while reading deliberately. My spirit prays, and my understanding is unfruitful concerning the tongue, so I give my mind to the Word for those hours.

Sometimes my head starts nodding because of the hours I put in. I may lie back and let sleep come over my soul for fifteen minutes, then go back, or jump up and do jumping jacks to get oxygen to my brain.

You need sleep because your mind has to stop actively serving you and sort out what has been fed into it. It separates short-term and long-term memory. If you keep a person awake long enough, he will break down because the mind must have time to sort.

The soul's assimilation is complicated. It is created for survival. It assimilates surroundings, languages, college atmospheres, whatever it is subjected to.

What would happen if you learned how to present the Word of God to your soul so it would assimilate it the way it assimilates everything else?

Sometimes I find myself eight or ten verses down and do not remember what I read. The way I broke myself of that was to go back to the last verse I remembered and pick it up again.

After correcting myself two or three hundred times, I learned to stick with it.

I tell people to read Proverbs fifty times without stopping for chapter studies, word studies, or reference studies, except to find out what words mean. After fifty times, you can go back and do any studies you want.

Why fifty times? Because you are equipping your spirit with the whole outline before you begin taking pieces apart.

I once thought I would use a bag of beans, moving one bean to another pile each time I finished the book. But since I carried my Bible with me, I began marking the front of Proverbs instead. I used groups of five marks and noted how far through the book I had read each time.

When God first taught me to do this, I did not know He was charging my battery and storing information in me for assimilation.

Later someone told me, "I did not realize how much I had assimilated until someone said something, and suddenly a whole teaching came out. I do not even know how I knew it."

I knew. They were assimilating it like a language.

You do not fully assimilate a language until life teaches it to you. Emotions, situations, necessities, and pressures teach it until it becomes part of you.

In the same way, the teaching time for Proverbs is connected with life. Assimilation becomes complete when Proverbs springs forward in business decisions and real-life situations. He takes a verse from here and another from there and teaches you in the moment.

After Proverbs, I asked God what should come next for someone called to stewardship. He gave me 1 John, 2 John, and 3 John.

Why? Because every place stewardship is mentioned, love is right there. Romans 12 talks about giving with simplicity and ruling with diligence, then ends with overcoming evil with good. First Corinthians 12 lists helps and governments, then moves immediately into 1 Corinthians 13 and agape love. Ephesians 4 lists the callings so the Body can edify itself in love.

If you are going to handle enough power to destroy people's lives, you must be transformed to the love of God. Otherwise you will use the power to destroy instead of bring life.

So after Proverbs, the next thing to assimilate is the love of God.

At the beginning of this year, God told me, "Son, I want you to begin giving yourself to the Word differently. I want you to go through it continually, consistently, time after time. Then I will give you books to go back and assimilate. Eventually I want to prophesy My mind in every book to the people."

He said, "I want to be able to come on you and pull it up as I move. You do not know how much you lose when you stop and do little intellectual breakdowns instead of letting Me bring the mind and content of the book."

He told me, "Assimilate it, son. The power lives there."

That is what has been coming more and more lately.

When we preached much prayer in the early days to preachers, many adopted the praying we taught. But I did not understand then the resistance to transformation.

There is someone who does not want you to meditate and does not want you to pray in the Holy Ghost. You have to become stronger than the average Christian to survive steady prayer, because you can be taken out smoothly and not even know what happened.

When you add meditation, you become very dangerous.

In those early days I locked myself up and prayed as a survival tactic. I was afraid I could not feed my family. I was afraid I would fail. I only did it to try to please God and give Him a legal right to bless me. I did not know what it would do.

When things got worse, I knew one thing: He sent me full-time because of a vision, and He was not sending me back. I had three little children, nowhere to preach, and nothing to fall into but a pit. I had to pray.

I only prayed in tongues to survive extended times in the closet. I did not know what it would do to me. Bless God for that day.

Out of many ministries I ordained, only a few survived. Others went elsewhere, backslid, or quit preaching. I called a preacher's conference, listened to them talk, saw what had happened, and preached about Satan's war machine.

I came home from Oregon shaking. I had not known the devil was so afraid of this.

We lost Augie for a while. He had every reason in the natural to turn on the faith move and on the prayer we taught. We trained him and put him full-time, yet he went from bad to worse. He had mental breakdowns, his wife came under torment, and he finally moved to India and just sat there, hardly knowing how to survive.

At times he said, "I threw my Bible against the wall and screamed at God, 'Where are You?'"

He wrote long letters to people he had turned on to faith, telling them to get out of it. For years he hid from me. Then one day he called me weeping, and I said, "Come home, Augie."

I asked him, "What stopped you from going crazy?"

He said, "I got to where I did not trust anybody. I did not know where to go get my food. Nothing was real."

I said, "I know that spirit, Augie." I taught him about Satan's war machine, and now he is out of it and back.

What did he do? He got his Bible and read it six hours a day minimum. He read the entire Old and New Testament every six weeks for a year. Everything God said pertinent to mankind passed through Augie every six weeks until his emotions stabilized.

If you have mental problems, one step out is to continually read the Word of God out loud. Replace your thoughts with His out loud. Speaking it adds another attribute to assimilation: the sound track as well as the visual.

When Augie came back, he told me about reading page after page. When he reached the boring measurements in the Old Testament, he worshiped God and thought, "If He cares this much about detail, He cares that much about detail in my life."

That stabilized him and turned him back to the Word.

Later he called me after a visitation, chattering like a little child. He said, "I saw what happened to me. I was an idiot, wasn't I?"

I said, "Yes, you were."

He said, "How did I let the devil deceive me like that?"

I said, "He is a master at it. You have to transform away from him."

Now the delight of Augie's day is running toward the prayer closet to spend six hours with God praying in tongues.

Psalm 1 says:

Blessed is the man that walketh not in the counsel of the ungodly,
Nor standeth in the way of sinners,
Nor sitteth in the seat of the scornful.

This man does not take counsel from the world. He does not do things the way sinners do. He does not sit in scorn, malice, strife, and bickering.

But his delight is in the law of the Lord; and in his law doth he meditate day and night.
And he shall be like a tree planted by the rivers of water...

We are talking about the Holy Ghost, the river that feeds your leaves when drought is in the land. Your roots sink deep until they find the river. Your tree bears fruit in due season because your meditation root system found the water.

The tree's leaf will not wither, and whatever it does prospers.

Why is this person blessed? Because he refuses to take counsel from the world, refuses to do things the way sinners do, refuses to sit in judgment and strife, and delights in the Word of God.

If I will not take my counsel from the world, then I have to get it from somewhere. His delight is in the Law of the Lord, and in it he meditates day and night.

That phrase "day and night" opened my channel to understand what meditation is.

I can tell you what meditation is by telling you what it is not. It is not reading, studying, or memorization. Those things assist meditation; they do not replace it.

I cannot read day and night. I cannot study day and night. I cannot memorize day and night. But I can meditate day and night.

When I deliberately give myself to the Word many times, I activate a process by which I can assimilate the Word of God. I am equipping my spirit for meditation day and night by assimilating the Word I am supposed to transform to.

When I assimilate that Word, I equip the Holy Spirit with what He needs to rise up anytime, anywhere in meditation and transform me to the meaning of what that Word says.

Why not stop and study one chapter for two or three weeks, then the next one? Because at that point you are not equipped.

What do you think false doctrine comes from? Picking letters apart.

There is much less danger if you have read the book fifty times deliberately and precisely while praying in tongues. There may be conclusion thoughts in later chapters that open earlier chapters, but you would not know that if you had not assimilated the book.

Assimilating the whole book makes the Holy Spirit's job easier. If He needs information from anywhere else in that book, He can pull it together, bring the Scripture to the forefront, and explode the revelation through your understanding.

When you assimilate entire books, they become keys to assimilating other books. One book finishes what another book begins. He can take life situations, emotions, business problems, and crises and use them to teach you the chapters you did not know you were assimilating.

These principles helped me break open some of the most difficult verses in the Word of God.

I do not know how many times I passed through Luke 16 on that marriage verse:

Whosoever putteth away his wife, and marrieth another, committeth adultery...

No ifs, buts, or clauses. When I assimilated the chapter, the Holy Ghost showed me that Jesus was answering people who accused Him of forsaking the Law. He was saying, "Israel, you know you are married to God through the Law. But I am God, and I am going to die. When I die, it will widow you and free you to marry another."

That is how the revelation opened.

Statements like "the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus hath made me free from the law of sin and death" also begin to open when you assimilate the argument of Romans. Romans 7 describes the law of sin and death: a spiritually dead man trying to do good and finding evil present with him. Romans 8 says the law of the Spirit of life has set him free.

When you assimilate, the Holy Spirit can work a verse in one chapter with a verse in another. These things begin to dance in your understanding.

When God approached Abraham, He asked whether Abraham believed He could quicken the dead. Quicken usually refers to the human spirit; resurrection refers to the flesh.

God was asking, "Do you believe I can quicken a dead spirit? Do you believe I can raise Jesus?"

Abraham believed, and God called things that were not as though they were. Abraham's spirit was dead as a doornail compared to the born-again nature we now have, but righteousness was put to his account to be paid in full.

The man in Romans 7 was spiritually dead, trying to keep the Law. God said, "Dead man, quit coveting," and he found that when he tried to do good, evil was present with him. Then Romans 8 declares there is no condemnation because the law of the Spirit of life has canceled the law of sin and death.

Jesus received the Spirit without measure. In the Old Testament, the Spirit came on people for a purpose, pursuit, or plan of God, and then backed off. Jesus said, "He is with you now, but in that day He shall be in you."

Why? Because you got born again. Like Jesus, you received the Holy Spirit without measure. He did not come for a season to part a Red Sea. He moved into you.

You have what Old Testament saints dreamed of having: a new nature, the ability to understand God, and the Holy Spirit as your personal Teacher.

God sent you a personal Teacher with a commission to guide you into all truth. John 17 says His Word is truth.

You have a personal tutor sent to instruct and teach the new nature you received from God, because that nature can understand God.

The Holy Ghost says, "It is time I move in and become their personal tutor. If I can get them to meditate the Word with their mind, then I can approach them with understanding. By the time we meet in the middle, there will be understanding."

That is when a person becomes a faith-filled, power-moving machine who does not depend on a weak message someone read from a book.

Do not take my Word from me. It is my life. It is what God wants me to be and where He wants me to go.

Give yourself to it. Take the time you need. You cannot live off someone else dealing with an issue a couple of times a week. That is why I deal so much with your personal relationship with God and what you can do to improve it.

We cannot give you enough do's, don'ts, and opinions to help you enough. You have to learn to assimilate the Word with Him.